Soundings

PROPOSAL

Self-service test data generator

Project	Internal Tools
Idea	TOOLS-3
Status	Proposal
Owner	Kenji Watanabe
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Score	Aggregate score 3.7 from 3 evaluations

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Summary

Generate realistic, anonymised test accounts and orders on demand.

Problem

Every team builds its own test accounts. QA spends about a day a sprint on it, and the payments team copies production data by hand, which the DPO wants stopped.

Solution

A small service in the developer portal that generates **realistic, anonymised** customers, orders and payment methods on demand:

- pick a scenario ("returning customer with a failed payment")
- get the accounts in staging within a minute
- everything generated is deleted after 30 days

Effort & rollout

Two developers for six weeks, then QA moves its scripts over. Roll out to QA first, then payments, then everyone.

Risks

- Generated data drifts from real data: QA reviews the scenarios each quarter.
- Teams keep copying production: we turn that access off once the generator covers their cases.

The ask

Two developers for six weeks from the next sprint, with QA and payments as the first users. We review the scenarios with QA after the first month.

Research and consultation

Not already being done elsewhere

QA has a script for orders only; the payments team copies production by hand. Nothing shared.

Answered by Kenji Watanabe on 12 September 2026

Departments or teams consulted

QA (test automation), 2 Sep: will help with the order rules. Payments: need card numbers that pass Luhn but never charge.

Answered by Kenji Watanabe on 12 September 2026

Data protection considered

Data protection officer, 3 Sep: fine as long as nothing is copied from production; generated data only.

Answered by Kenji Watanabe on 12 September 2026